



Above Rare roast beef, roast potatoes, roast parsnips, and Yorkshire pudding await the gravy

Left Old meets new on the Thames, where passengers on the London Eye look straight across the river at Big Ben



Above Interior of Rules restaurant, a London institution specializing in British cookery – roast meats and game, oysters, pies, and puddings

Borough Market

As colorful as London itself, Borough Market is one of the oldest, biggest, and most popular food markets in London. There has been a market here in the Southwark area near a crossing point on the Thames River since at least the 11th century. Here you'll find an amazing array of produce to buy and try, not just from in and around London and the UK but from all over the world. There are artisan bakers, butchers, and fishmongers selling everything from Lincolnshire sausages and Melton Mowbray pork pies to oysters and trout, along with stands selling nothing but olives or jellies, honey or pâtés. Open Thu–Sat; www.boroughmarket.org.uk

The Best Places to Eat Roast Beef

Rules expensive

To step into Rules in Covent Garden is to step back in time: it was founded in 1798 and is the oldest restaurant in the city. In all that time it has been owned by only three families, and its history is told on the walls and in the various atmospheric dining rooms that fill the old building. Many famous people have dined at Rules, including Charles Dickens, Charlie Chaplin, and Laurence Olivier, and memorabilia from many of the illustrious diners is displayed for the entertainment of present-day diners. The menu remains resolutely traditional British, and they serve Aberdeenshire sirloin of beef with roast potatoes and Yorkshire pudding as a grand dish for two people. Game features heavily on the menu, changing with the seasons, and their British “nursery-style” desserts – golden syrup sponge, lemon meringue pie, and rice pudding – are renowned. Dining at Rules is more than just a meal, it's a British institution.

35 Maiden Lane, Covent Garden, WC2; open noon–11.45 PM Mon–Sat, noon–10.45 PM Sun; www.rules.co.uk

Also in London

Simpson's in the Strand (www.simpsonsinthestrnd.co.uk; *expensive*) typifies traditional London formality with its wood paneling, chandeliers, silver-domed serving trays, and immaculate staff. Roast beef is one of its signature dishes, carved at the table and served with roast potatoes, Savoy cabbage, Yorkshire pudding, and horseradish. Or have your Sunday lunch with all the trimmings in the **National Dining Rooms** (www.thenationaldiningrooms.co.uk; *moderate*), the excellent restaurant that is part of the National Gallery on Trafalgar Square.

Also in England

The Hardwick Inn (www.hardwickinn.co.uk; *inexpensive*) in Derbyshire is a unique 15th-century sandstone inn owned by the National Trust, Britain's guardian of heritage properties, and a rare place that serves roast beef, locally sourced, from its Carvery restaurant almost every day of the week.

Around the World

The original **Lawry's The Prime Rib** in Beverly Hills (www.lawrysonline.com; *expensive*) specializes in ribs and roasts and serves its roast beef accompanied with Yorkshire pudding and creamed horseradish. Expect London gentleman's club decor, with dark wood and thick carpets; plenty of theatrics such as tableside carving and flambéing; and impeccable service.